

L E S S O N 07

# Does Grace Give You a License to Sin?

## 2: Eternal Security

**Scripture Focus:** *Romans 6:1-2 · Romans 6:1-14 · Galatians 5:13*

Some argue that teaching eternal security encourages believers to live carelessly. Paul answers directly: “By no means! How can we who died to sin still live in it?” Eternal security is not a license to sin — it's a motivation for gratitude and holiness that flows from the Holy Spirit's work in every true believer.

BY THE END

## You Will...

|          |                                                                                           |
|----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A</b> | <b>Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.</b>                          |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Connect the main truth to Romans 6:1-2 and Romans 6:1-14 and Galatians 5:13.</b>       |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.</b> |

VOCABULARY

### Key Terms

| THEME      | STUDY NOTE                                                                                                                  |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sin</b> | Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue. |

| THEME              | STUDY NOTE                                                                                                           |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Salvation</b>   | God's gracious rescue of sinners through the finished work of Christ, received by faith rather than earned by works. |
| <b>Grace</b>       | God's unearned favor toward sinners, shown supremely in Christ and active in the believer's growth.                  |
| <b>Holy Spirit</b> | The divine Person who indwells, teaches, convicts, empowers, and forms believers into the likeness of Christ.        |
| <b>Faith</b>       | Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.                |

## TEACHING NOTES

### I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see grace and holiness from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. Some argue that teaching eternal security encourages believers to live carelessly. Paul answers directly: "By no means! How can we who died to sin still live in it?" Eternal security is not a license to sin — it's a motivation for gratitude and holiness that flows from the Holy Spirit's work in every true believer.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

### II. What Scripture Says

Romans 6:1-2 and Romans 6:1-14 and Galatians 5:13 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. In Philippians 1:6 we are told and I am sure of this that he who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ. Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

### **III. The Doctrine Explained**

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. It continues through sanctification or the growth of the believer and it ultimately culminates or ends in glorification when we get to heaven and we fully experience the full ramifications of our salvation. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

### **SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT**

#### **Romans 6:1-2**

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Romans 6:1-2 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read Romans 6:1-2 first, then read Romans 6:1-14 and Galatians 5:13. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

He says, But I, brothers, could not address you as spiritual people, but as people of the flesh, as infants in Christ. In other words, what Paul is saying here is, I'd love to write to you on a spiritual level, but I can't because you're not living to that level.

#### **Study the passage:**

1. *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*

2. *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
3. *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*

#### FRAMEWORK

##### Assurance vs. Presumption

| ASSURANCE                                             | PRESUMPTION                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Resting in God's promises and Christ's finished work. | Using grace as an excuse for careless sin.       |
| Looking for the Spirit's fruit as evidence of life.   | Ignoring correction while claiming security.     |
| Confidence that leads to gratitude and holiness.      | Confidence that avoids repentance and obedience. |

#### PAUSE & REFLECT

*Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does grace and holiness most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?*

#### IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. We've already mentioned that salvation is not based on us, but rather it is the work of our God. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

#### V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. often times in our Christian lives you have these peaks where we do very well and then we may have a valley

experience where we get involved in sin or so forth but then there's another period of growth in our walk. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

## VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Grace and holiness belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. eternal life truly means forever. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

### KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **grace and holiness should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **As believers understand more of God's faithfulness, they're encouraged to live faithfully, joyfully, and confidently in Christ.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

### REFLECTION

## Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about grace and holiness?*

**2.** *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

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**3.** *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

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#### PUT INTO PRACTICE

## A Discipleship Conversation

*Imagine a newer believer asks you about grace and holiness. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.*

#### **Your Task**

**1.** Use Romans 6:1-2 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

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**2.** Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

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**3.** Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.

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